Building Bridges, Creating Opportunities, Shaping Tomorrow



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Foreword

Singapore occupies a distinctive position in the global economy. As a compact and highly developed city-state, it has established enduring strengths in financial services, advanced manufacturing, international trade, technology, logistics and global connectivity. At the same time, its constraints of land, population and natural resources have shaped an outward-looking economic strategy focused on international partnerships, innovation and integration with global value chains.

India and Singapore share a longstanding Strategic Partnership, supported by the India-Singapore Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA), strong investment linkages and an expanding agenda of cooperation across digitalisation, advanced manufacturing, skills development, sustainability, healthcare, infrastructure and connectivity. Singapore remains an important investment partner for India and a strategic gateway to the wider ASEAN region, while India offers Singapore access to a vast and growing market, a deep talent pool, expanding manufacturing capabilities and a dynamic technology ecosystem.

The Knowledge Paper examines, in a structured and evidence-based manner, how CCI India can serve as a strategic bridge between Singapore's capital, technology, innovation and global business capabilities and India's market, manufacturing strengths and talent base. It presents a sector-wise assessment across fifteen priority areas, maps key institutional and business stakeholders, and outlines a practical roadmap of initiatives, priorities and actions for strengthening India–Singapore economic and business engagement.

The paper is intended to serve as a valuable reference for CCI India's engagement with Singaporean government agencies, business chambers, industry leaders and enterprises. It also seeks to support Indian businesses in identifying opportunities for trade, investment, technology partnerships, market expansion and deeper integration with Singapore and the wider ASEAN region.



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SINGAPORE

> Explore a dynamic city where cultures blend seamlessly. Every moment reflects innovation, diversity, and urban sophistication.



Basic Facts and Demographics

Singapore is a highly developed city-state in Southeast Asia with a population of about 6 million people and is recognized as a major global financial and trade hub. Its official currency is the Singapore Dollar (SGD), and due to its strategic location, efficient governance, and strong global connectivity,

The country is known for its multicultural population, with major ethnic groups including Chinese, Malay, and Indian communities living harmoniously. It has four official languages—English, Malay, Mandarin, and Tamil—reflecting its cultural diversity. Singapore also boasts a high standard of living, excellent healthcare, and a world-class education system. Its urban planning, cleanliness, and safety make it one of the most livable cities in the world.

Economic Landscape and Gross Domestic Product (GDP)

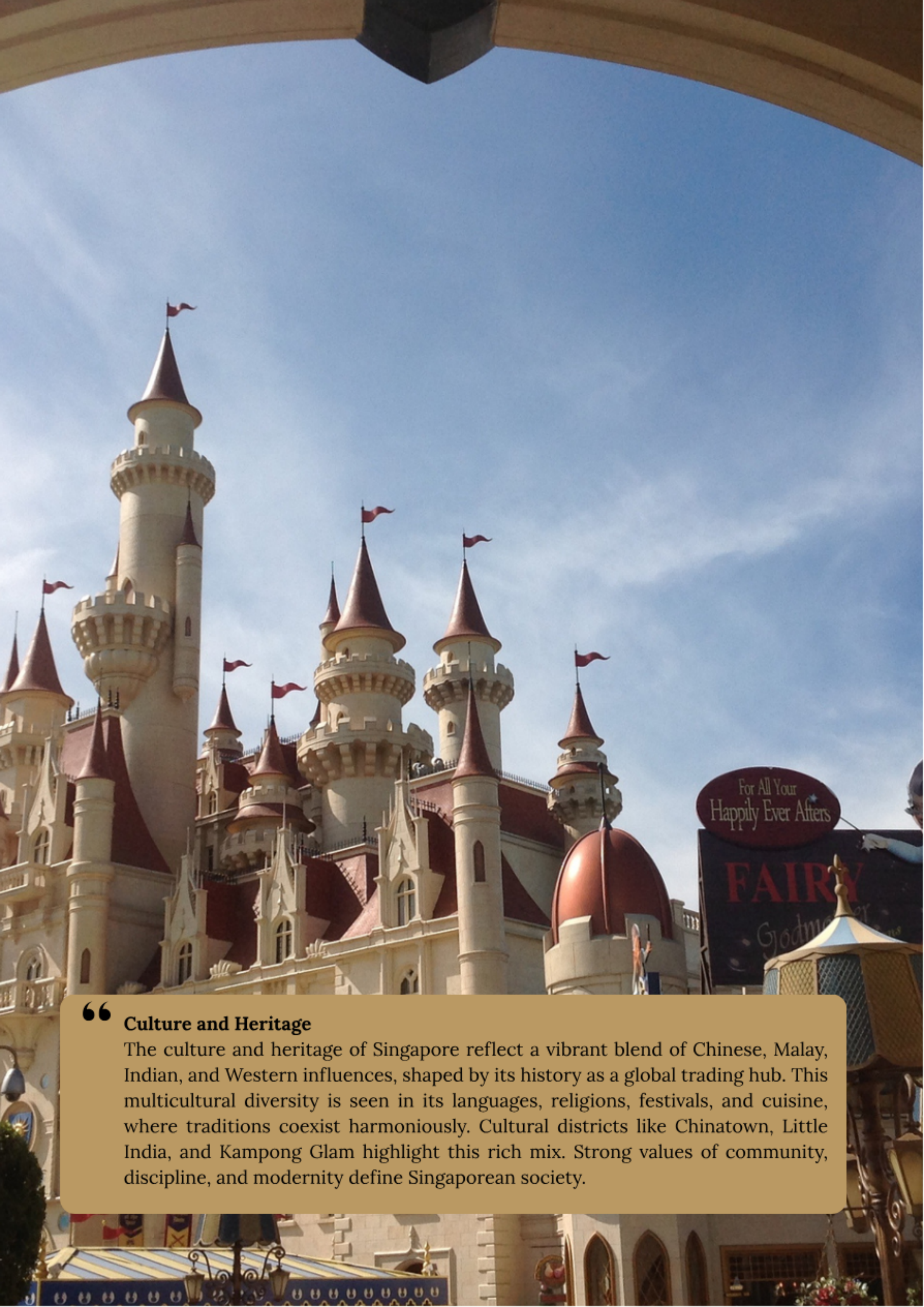
Singapore's GDP is approximately USD 600 billion, reflecting its strong and stable economy. The country's economic landscape is highly diversified, with key sectors including finance, global trade, logistics, and advanced manufacturing driving growth. It consistently ranks among the most competitive and business-friendly economies in the world due to its strong institutions, transparent governance, and world-class infrastructure. In addition, Singapore benefits from a highly skilled workforce and a strategic location that facilitates international commerce. Its pro-business policies, low corruption levels, and emphasis on innovation and technology further strengthen its position as a leading global economic hub.

The primary sectors contributing to GDP are:

Services: The service sector dominates, including banking, finance, tourism, and global trade services. It contributes the largest share to GDP and employment.

Industry: Key industries include electronics, chemicals, and precision engineering, supported by advanced technology and innovation.

Agriculture: Agriculture contributes minimally due to limited land, with a focus on imports and food security strategies.



Culture and Heritage

The culture and heritage of Singapore reflect a vibrant blend of Chinese, Malay, Indian, and Western influences, shaped by its history as a global trading hub. This multicultural diversity is seen in its languages, religions, festivals, and cuisine, where traditions coexist harmoniously. Cultural districts like Chinatown, Little India, and Kampong Glam highlight this rich mix. Strong values of community, discipline, and modernity define Singaporean society.

India–Singapore Bilateral Trade and Economic Ties

India and Singapore share strong bilateral trade and economic ties, with Singapore being the largest sources of foreign direct investment (FDI) in India. Bilateral trade exceeds USD 34 billion and is supported by the Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA), which enhances trade and investment flows. Singapore also serves as a key financial and investment gateway for Indian companies looking to expand into Southeast Asia. Cooperation extends to sectors such as technology, infrastructure, fintech, and smart cities, strengthening economic integration.

Economic Ties and Connectivity

India and Singapore share strong economic ties supported by excellent air and maritime connectivity, which enables smooth and efficient trade flows. Singapore acts as a key financial gateway for investments into India and other Asian markets. In addition, robust shipping links through major ports and frequent direct flights strengthen business, tourism, and corporate exchanges between the two countries. This connectivity further supports regional supply chains and enhances economic cooperation across multiple sectors.

Key Players in Import and Export

Traders:

Multinational corporations and global trading firms play a dominant role in international trade.

Industries:

Finance, logistics, and high-tech manufacturing industries are key contributors to exports and services.

Logistics:

The Port of Singapore is one of the busiest and most efficient in the world, supporting global trade networks.

Government:

Pro-business policies, trade agreements, and investment frameworks drive economic growth.



Trade Balance and Key Export–Import Commodities

Singapore maintains a strong and dynamic trade balance, supported by its position as a global trading hub. Its exports mainly include electronics, machinery, chemicals, refined petroleum products, and financial services, which are key drivers of its economy. Singapore is also one of the world's leading exporters of high-tech goods and plays a major role in re-export trade due to its strategic port location. On the import side, it brings in crude oil, machinery, food products, and raw materials needed for processing and re-export. Its extensive global trade network and free trade agreements enhance its connectivity with major economies such as China, the United States, and regional ASEAN countries.

1. Singapore: Country and Economic Overview

1.1 Geography and Political System

The Republic of Singapore is an island city-state located at the southern tip of the Malay Peninsula, at the crossroads of major East-West shipping lanes connecting the Indian Ocean and the South China Sea via the Strait of Malacca. Singapore has a total land area of approximately 734 square kilometres, making it one of the smallest sovereign states in the world by land area, a constraint that shapes nearly every dimension of its economic strategy, from housing and food policy to industrial land allocation.

Singapore is a parliamentary republic with a Westminster-style system of government. The President serves as Head of State, while executive authority rests with the Prime Minister and the Cabinet, drawn from the party or coalition commanding a majority in Parliament. Singapore has been governed continuously by the People's Action Party (PAP) since independence in 1965, providing a long record of policy continuity that has underpinned its economic development model.

1.2 Population and Demographics

Singapore's total population, comprising citizens, permanent residents and non-resident workers and dependents, stood at approximately 6.11 million in 2025, according to Singapore Department of Statistics data compiled by Trading Economics. The resident population (citizens and permanent residents) forms a smaller subset of this total. Singapore's demographic profile is characterised by low fertility and a rapidly ageing citizen population, a structural challenge examined in detail in the chapter on Singapore's major challenges.

1.3 Economic Model and Structure

Singapore operates one of the world's most open, trade-dependent economies. Its Gross Domestic Product was approximately US$ 572-573 billion in nominal terms in 2024, with GDP growth of approximately 4.4% in 2024 moderating to an estimated 2.0% in 2025 amid a more uncertain global trade environment. Singapore's GDP per capita places it among the highest in the world on a nominal basis, reflecting its status as an advanced, high-income economy.

By sector, services account for the large majority of Singapore's GDP, with the balance concentrated in advanced manufacturing (notably electronics, semiconductors, precision engineering, biomedical manufacturing, and chemicals) and a very small agriculture sector reflecting the country's land constraints. Singapore's main industries include electronics, financial services, information and communications technology, civil engineering, petroleum refining and trading, chemical products, biomedical products, marine and offshore engineering, and re-export trade.

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1.4 Trade Orientation and Global Connectivity

Singapore's trade-to-GDP ratio is among the highest of any economy in the world, reflecting its role as an entrepot and re-export hub. The Port of Singapore is one of the world's busiest container ports and transshipment hubs, and Changi Airport is a leading global air cargo and passenger hub. Singapore is a member of the World Trade Organization, APEC, the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP), the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP), and ASEAN, and has one of the largest networks of bilateral and regional free trade agreements of any economy in the world.

1.5 Business Environment and Global Competitiveness

Singapore consistently ranks among the world's most competitive and business-friendly economies, reflecting political stability, rule of law, low corruption (Singapore scored 84 out of 100 on Transparency International's 2024 Corruption Perceptions Index, placing it among the least corrupt countries globally), efficient regulation, strong intellectual property protection, and a highly skilled workforce. These attributes make Singapore the preferred regional headquarters location for a large number of multinational corporations operating across ASEAN and the wider Asia-Pacific region.

1.6 Financial Centre Status

Singapore is one of the world's leading international financial centres, alongside New York, London and Hong Kong, anchored by the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS), which functions simultaneously as the central bank and integrated financial regulator. Singapore's financial sector encompasses banking, asset management, insurance, capital markets, FinTech and a growing wealth management industry serving both regional and global clients.

1.7 Technology and Innovation Ecosystem

Singapore has invested heavily in building a technology and innovation ecosystem through agencies including the Agency for Science, Technology and Research), Enterprise Singapore, and the Economic Development Board (EDB), alongside targeted national initiatives in artificial intelligence, quantum technology, cybersecurity and space technology, the last now coordinated through the newly established National Space Agency of Singapore (NSAS). Singapore's Smart Nation programme has positioned the country as a regional leader in digital government and digital economy infrastructure.

1.8 Singapore's Role in ASEAN

Singapore functions as the de facto financial, legal and business services capital of ASEAN and is frequently the preferred base for multinational and Indian companies seeking a regional headquarters for Southeast Asian operations.

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